

So, you want to get the best insights on how to get started with augmented reality on the best softwares. You've probably seen what the sources have to offer and are just taken aback at the amount of work required to pull off something in AR. Don't let that bring you down, all beginners feel a sense of insecurity that lapses away as they get better and better.

That's exactly the purpose of this chapter. To get you up and going on your first project with some simple use cases and some useful tips.

WORKING WITH ARKIT

Augmented reality is everywhere these days with handheld devices being the best adherents of the technology that's sweeping the younger generation mainly through features on social media and gaming.

To create the elements of ARKit, you can either use the elements from the store or create them yourself if you've got a knack for design.

The best extensions that are used to create such elements happen to be Unity 3D, Unreal and the more commonly used Blender on Windows systems.

While Unity first started life as an Apple-only 3D engine, it now has many platforms and architectures working under its development environment. It can be downloaded easily for no cost and be used for creating designs. Unity 3D engine provides an ARKit specific plugin that is well suited for AR projects. Coming to the Unreal Engine, it is a service engine for creating elaborate animations and 3D imagery, mainly for games and short videos. Blender is another variant that can be downloaded to work on creating AR apps since the software has a well-defined user interface that makes learning animation templates easier.

To make AR apps, ensure that you have macOS High Sierra or higher and get all the necessary updates to Metal and GPU drivers. Download the experimental version of Unity with a Swift code enhanced by Cocoa and Objective-C.

Begin working with the environment by navigating to the `info.plist` file and enabling camera usage so that all renders can be transferred to other devices.

Next, add some AR capabilities to the app by going to the main storyboard and dropping the ARKit SceneKit View on the ViewController. Pin the `ARSCNView` to the same tab.

Use the user preference tab to create an `IBOutlet` for the ViewController class and import any ARKit packages to it.